more flexible on the subject of Jerusalem. It is also agreed that the Palestinian state will be demilitarized.

In January 2007, the Arab world signaled to Israel that the initiative was not set in stone but rather was a basis for negotiations. On July 8, 2014, the Saudi prince Turki al-Faisal published an article in *Ha'aretz* in which he explicitly stated that the proposal was not a prescription but a template for negotiations.

Discussion

The use of the Saudi Initiative as a tool for advancing a regional settlement will require the diplomatic and intellectual efforts of all parties involved. It will necessitate thinking creatively, "outside the box" of many of the paradigms that both sides have established throughout the history of the conflict. As mentioned, the Israeli-Palestinian conflict is unique in several ways:

- There is no real and reciprocal recognition of the other's right to exist.
- There is no mutual reconciliation.
- There is a mutual claim on the same piece of land.
- The nature of the armed conflict (asymmetric) and the arena of the conflict (the civilian battlefield) do not allow Israel to exercise its full military capability.
- Our enemy—the Palestinians—lives geographically within our borders.

Our peace with Egypt and Jordan only reinforces the uniqueness of the Israeli-Palestinian conflict, and the objective difficulty in finding a solution to it. Of the core issues of the conflict, two are anchored in the Palestinian national, cultural, and religious ethos. These are, of course, the "right of return" and the holy places in Jerusalem ("the Holy Basin").

I propose a symmetrical formula by which the Palestinians understand that the "right of return" is an unrealistic dream rooted in the values of their national-historical culture. In the same vein, I suggest that the Israeli equivalent of this dream is the vision of a "Greater Israel," and that the same logic applies to Jerusalem. The belief or aspiration of "it's all mine" will have to be abandoned by each side. Both parties will have to learn to